

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner for data platforms, airline domain.*

Positioning, Data-platform product owner with 13 years of cross-functional delivery, now targeting airline-domain data initiatives in Abu Dhabi.

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§ WHY HTC GLOBAL SERVICES

HTC's airline-domain data engagement sits at exactly the intersection I have been building toward: translating complex operational workflows into executable data product backlogs, and driving them through Scrum ceremonies with engineering, QA, architecture, and business stakeholders at the table. The posting's explicit emphasis on UAT coordination and continuous backlog refinement maps directly to how I operate every sprint. The airline domain is new to me as an industry label, but the underlying mechanics, high-stakes transactional data, strict latency and accuracy requirements, cross-team dependency management, are structural neighbours of the defence AI platform and national analytics work I have already shipped.

That is precisely the kind of high-dependency environment where disciplined backlog ownership and stakeholder alignment produce outsized results.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case drafting
- **GitHub Copilot**, accelerating acceptance criteria and story templates
- **Cursor / VSCode**, code-assisted requirements validation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototype for stakeholder demos
- **Gamma.app**, structured product roadmap presentations
- **GPT**, fast synthesis of stakeholder interview notes

- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation for backlog triage pipelines
 - **Jira + Confluence**, sprint management and documentation (daily use)
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, REST APIs, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Git, Matomo, MicroStrategy, SQL, OpenShift, Red Hat, Jira, Confluence.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT HTC GLOBAL SERVICES

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the data engineering and architecture teams, audit the existing backlog for completeness of acceptance criteria, and map the airline-domain data flows to identify where requirements are ambiguous or dependencies are undocumented.

WEEK 2

Prioritise, slice, validate.

Run a structured backlog refinement session with engineering, QA, and business stakeholders to reorder items by business value and delivery risk, producing a sprint-ready top-10 with clear acceptance criteria.

WEEK 3+

Ship, track, close.

Facilitate the first full sprint cycle end-to-end, planning, daily stand-up, review, and retrospective, establish the UAT sign-off rhythm with the business team, and instrument delivery metrics so progress is visible to all stakeholders from day one.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at HTC Global Services,

I am writing to express my interest in the Product Owner (Data) contract role you have posted for the airline domain in Abu Dhabi. Abu Dhabi is one of my actively targeted locations, so this is not a compromise on either side: I am ready to relocate and work fully on-site.

The core of what you are looking for, a Product Owner who owns the backlog end-to-end, translates business requirements into user stories and acceptance criteria, and keeps engineering, QA, architecture, and business stakeholders moving in the same direction through tight Scrum cadences, is precisely the work I have been doing for over a decade. At Rohde & Schwarz I drove a cross-functional team of 15 engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence on an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme: I ran Sprint Planning, Sprint Reviews, and backlog refinement every fortnight, and I kept the release cadence honest by instrumenting competing delivery approaches and redirecting strategy when the data said to. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform from backlog to deployment: I introduced Dagster and dbt to eliminate manual data update effort and carried a full ETL migration and UI relaunch through the same sprint cycle without stalling the team.

What makes data projects hard is rarely the technology. It is the gap between what business stakeholders ask for and what data engineers can actually build in a sprint, and it widens every time a story lands in refinement with vague acceptance criteria. I close that gap by treating stakeholder interviews as product discovery, writing acceptance criteria before I write the story title, and running UAT coordination as a product responsibility rather than a QA handoff. At CLINET Platforms I cut a five-person team's roadmap to its highest-value 10% against agreed success measures, and user acceptance rose more than fivefold as a direct result.

I have 8 years of experience working with data-intensive systems in regulated and mission-critical environments, and 13 years of hands-on backlog ownership across insurance, healthcare, public-sector analytics, and defence. I work comfortably in fully Agile and SAFe setups, I know Jira and Confluence as daily instruments rather than reporting tools, and I carry enough technical depth in Python, SQL, ETL pipelines, and containerised environments to hold a meaningful conversation with a data engineer without asking them to slow down.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background maps to the airline-domain data initiatives HTC is delivering for its Abu Dhabi client. Please find my CV attached.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated, data-intensive environments. I have owned the full backlog lifecycle, discovery, refinement, sprint execution, and UAT sign-off, on AI and data platforms in defence, public-sector analytics, healthcare, and insurance. I lead cross-functional teams through Scrum and SAFe delivery, translate complex business requirements into executable user stories and acceptance criteria, and hold stakeholder alignment across engineering, data, QA, and architecture simultaneously.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, Sprint Planning, sprint review, retrospective, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, agile release train, PI planning, WIP limits

Analytics and Data: ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL, KPI definition, funnel analysis, Matomo, MicroStrategy

SDLC and Delivery: GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, containerised environments, regression and end-to-end test automation, release gating, cycle time as product metric

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, OpenShift, Python, Kotlin, REST APIs, MongoDB, Kafka, Azure DevOps, GitLab

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, Explainable AI (XAI), EU AI Act, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget and financial planning

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA 2024-2025

Owned backlog and Scrum delivery for an internal AI and data platform across 15+ engineers and data scientists (FCAS programme). Increased pipeline runs 200% by redirecting strategy based on instrumented workflow data; reduced rollout time to 30 minutes via GitOps with ArgoCD. Jira and Confluence throughout.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Owned national labour-market analytics platform. Introduced Dagster and dbt, cutting data-update effort by 75%. Carried ETL migration and full UI relaunch in parallel; Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023

Cut backlog to highest-value 10% against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold. Shipped CGM/KIS integration, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 to 5 minutes.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition dropped to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

SAFe delivery across agile release trains; moved research results to production in a matrix organisation with PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated legacy procurement webshop to Shopware for three AOK insurers and 20,000 employees. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals in a clinical network.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING 2025-PRESENT

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace. Anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/
Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel. Funnel and conversion analysis in
SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · IT SECURITY 2016-2021

Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software; three-layer product installing in under two
minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRITECH
2018-2021

Laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH 2013-2018

Mobile P2P group payments built from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the
girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · HTC GLOBAL SERVICES

